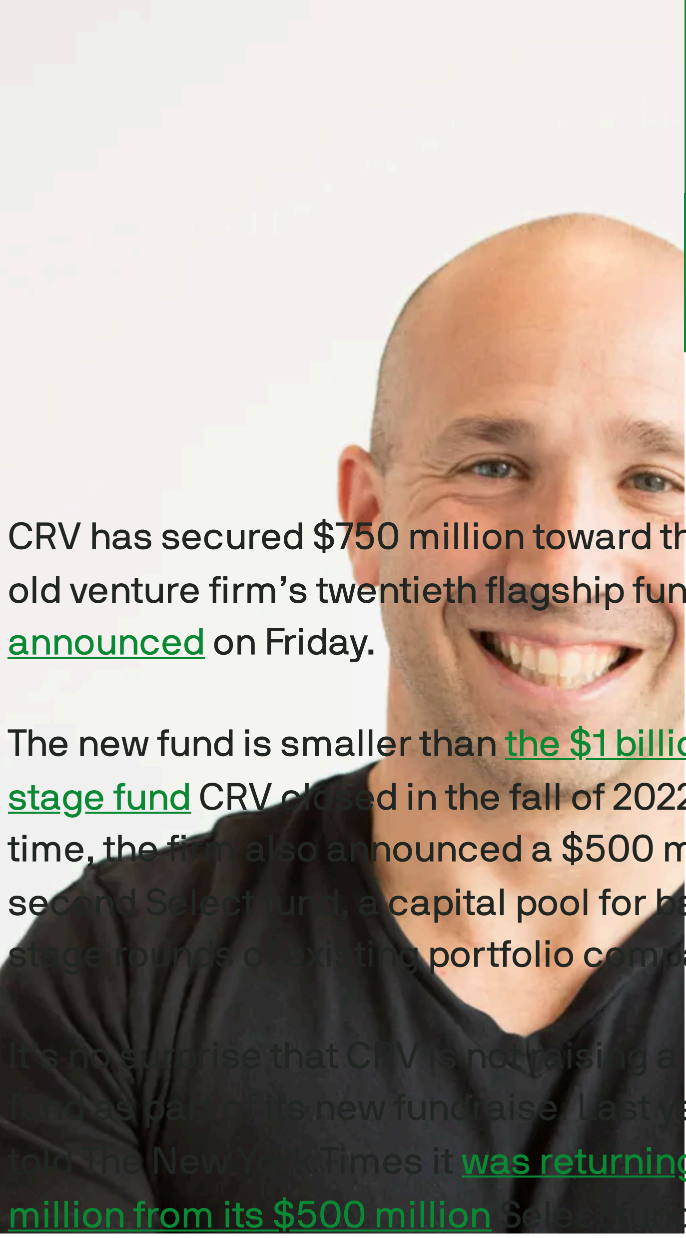
VENTURE

Venture firm CRV raises $750M, downsizing after returning capital to investors

Marina Temkin — 4:22 PM PDT · August 1, 2025



CRV has secured $750 million toward the 55-year-old venture firm's twentieth flagship fund, it announced on Friday.

The new fund is smaller than the $1 billion early-stage fund CRV closed in the fall of 2022. At that time, the firm also announced a $500 million second Select fund, a capital pool for backing late-stage rounds of existing portfolio companies.

It's no surprise that CRV is not raising a late-stage fund as part of its new fundraise. Last year, the firm told the New York Times it was returning $275 million from its $500 million Select fund to investors. The firm explained that it would not be raising another late-stage vehicle because follow-on rounds for many of its companies would lower its overall returns.

IMAGE CREDITS: SAAR GUR

CRV's limited partners were eager to back the firm's smaller fund, the firm said. It raised its entire $750 million fund in just four weeks, with demand for double that amount, CRV wrote.

The latest fund will be used to invest in seed and Series A startups and it will focus on backing consumer and devtools companies.

CRV is known for leading DoorDash's seed financing and the Series A rounds for both Mercury and Vercel, a cloud platform for web developers, which was last valued at $3.25 billion.

Since its founding in 1970, CRV has backed over 750 startups, with 80 of them eventually going public.

The firm's latest investments include CodeRabbit, a startup for AI code review, and Outtake, a company that uses AI for cybersecurity.

Topics: CRV early stage venture Venture

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Marina Temkin is a venture capital and startups reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining TechCrunch, she wrote abou...

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CRV just put advanced bioengineering on its shopping list

Connie Loizos 1:57 PM PDT · March 30, 2017

CRV, an early-stage venture firm that made headlines last year for its stance on then-candidate Donald Trump's campaign, is looking to get out a new (non-political) message: It's diving more deeply into the business of AI-driven biotech.

The move comes years after some other venture firms have taken a deep dive into biotech, including True Ventures and Andreessen Horowitz. But CRV general partner George Zachary would argue that CRV's timing is pretty good, given both the burgeoning opportunity and the potential outcomes.

Consider that late last year, Stanford researchers trained a computer to identify images of skin cancer moles and lesions as accurately as a dermatologist. Entrepreneur and computer scientist Sebastian Thrun — who was involved in the project as an adjunct professor in the Stanford Artificial Intelligence Laboratory — told us earlier this year that the researchers are forming a startup around their findings. (Natch.)

Another young company, Viz, is applying deep learning to ultrasounds, which typically require either a radiologist or other technician's expertise (which can translate into a long wait for anxious patients). More specifically, Viz's software compares ultrasounds with millions of other images and videos, ostensibly empowering primary care physicians to interpret the images and quickly take action.

And these are but two in a sea of examples that range from cancer screening to blood testing to human microbiome-focused startups (which alone number in the dozens).

What finally captured CRV's interest? In part, it was personal, says Zachary, who had his own health scare several years ago when a large tumor was detected near his hip. For weeks, doctors thought he had sarcoma; they later discovered he did not, but today's more advanced testing would have saved him a month's worth of anguish.

Zachary doesn't say so, but likely institutional investors see the same opportunity that VCs have spied, too, and CRV closed its most recent fund with $393 million in 2014. You'd expect that it might raise another fund in 2017 (if it's not actively in the market already); you might also expect that some focus on biotech might elicit even more enthusiasm from those investors.

For what it's worth, Zachary — whose past investments include the enterprise social network Yammer (acquired in 2012), the genealogy-focused social networking platform Geni (also acquired in 2012) and the education platform Udacity (co-founded by Thrun) — says CRV doesn't plan to create a separate fund around advanced bioengineering. But he says that going forward, it will be his focus exclusively.

"It took me awhile to figure this out," he says. But "like something staring me in the face," he finally decided to "put my work behind my passion."

Founders, take note.

Topics: Artificial Intelligence (AI) biotech CRV George Zachary Venture

Connie Loizos

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Loizos has been reporting on Silicon Valley since the late ’90s, when she joined the original Red Herring magazine....

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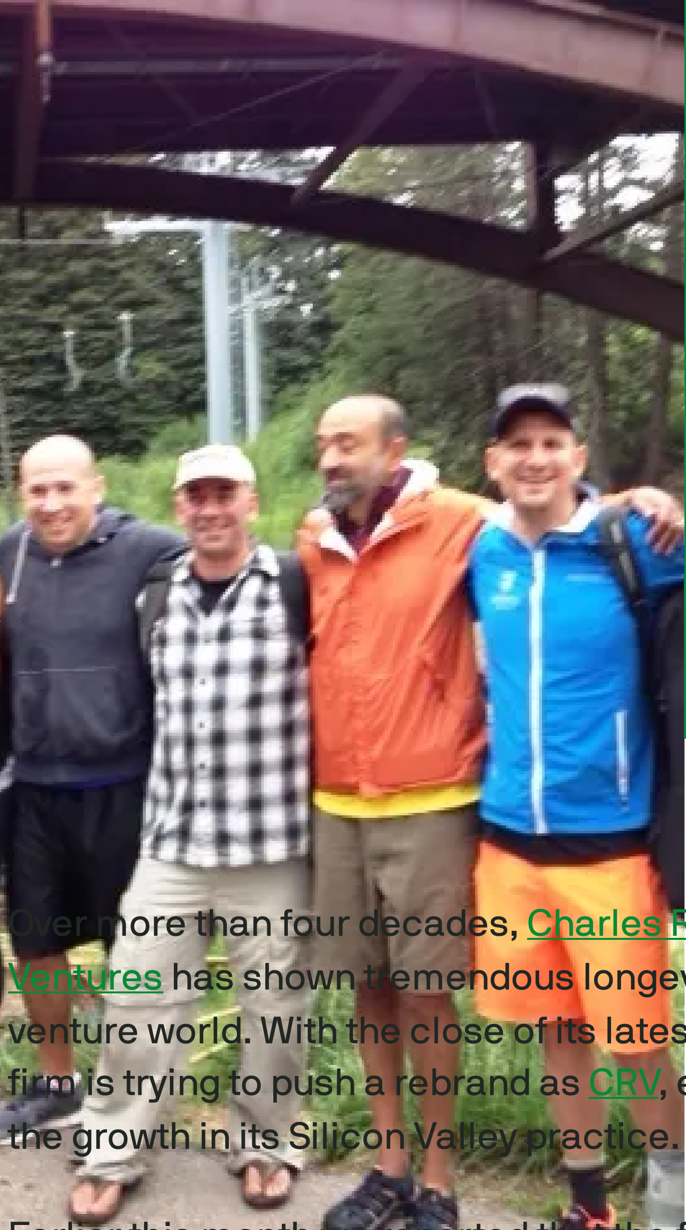


Now That Charles River Ventures Has Closed Its 16th Fund, It Wants To Be Called CRV

Ryan Lawler — 7:00 AM PDT · July 14, 2014

Over more than four decades, Charles River Ventures has shown tremendous longevity in the venture world. With the close of its latest fund, the firm is trying to push a rebrand as CRV, emphasizing the growth in its Silicon Valley practice.

Earlier this month we reported that the firm had closed its 16th fund, which was worth close to $400 million according to SEC documents. Well, the firm has confirmed that it closed that fund, which it will use to continue investing in early-stage startups.

After 44 years in the business, you figure out what works and what doesn't. CRV has had eight exits with $1 billion valuations or above over the last decade. Only Sequoia Capital, Greylock Partners, and New Enterprise Associates have as many so-called "unicorn" exits in the same time period.

Since it also invests early, CRV's wins tend to be outsized compared to the rest of the market to the market. It was the first institutional investor in companies like Twitter, Zendesk, and Yammer, for instance.

The latest fund is a small step up from the last one it closed, which was for $375 million back in early 2012. As a result, there are certain things that haven't changed much for CRV.

For one, the firm is singularly focused on investing in early-stage startups, at the Series A level.

According to general partner Jon Auerbach, the $300-$400 million range is the sweet spot for a fund like CRV, as it gives the firm more than enough money to make follow-on investments in its winners. But it's not so overcapitalized that the firm is forced to make growth investments or go off-model.

CRV plans to invest in 25-35 companies over the three-year life of the fund, with the average amount invested in each company being around $10 million. But the bulk of the fund is held in reserve for it to back companies that will have those outsized exits — whether that means an IPO or an acquisition.

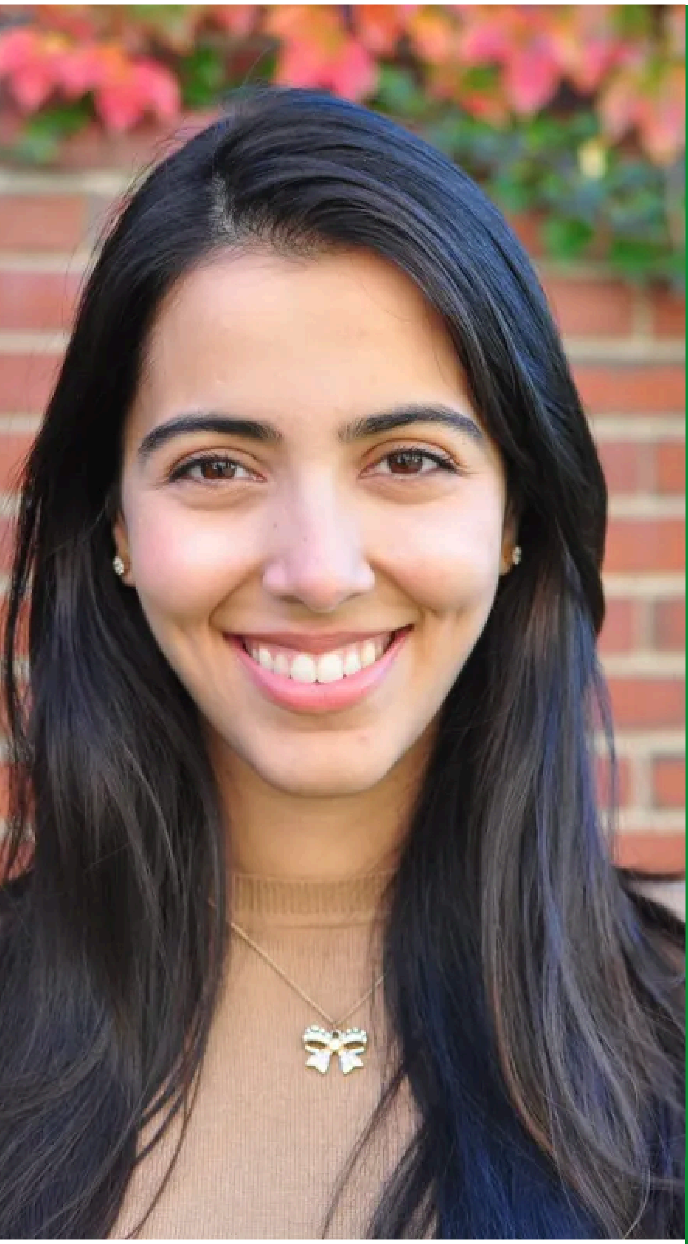
What has changed over the years, and will continue with the new fund, is CRV's increased investment in startups in Silicon Valley.

Originally named after the river that runs between Boston and Cambridge, the firm has spent the last decade re-inventing itself with a Silicon Valley office. After decades of betting mostly on infrastructure companies that emerged out of the Boston area, CRV opened a Silicon Valley office in 2004 and has been steadily growing its presence there.

With the close of the new fund, the firm is hoping to emphasize the new-look CRV, which is increasingly focused on investing in West Coast, consumer-focused startups. It has more partners in Silicon Valley than in Cambridge, and that mix is also reflected in the types of companies it's invested in, and the types of companies that have had the most success in the last decade.

"We believe there are a finite number of change-the-world entrepreneurs... and the place that they congregate is in San Francisco and Silicon Valley," Auerbach said. Since most of its biggest recent wins were from investments in that area, it's probably a smart bet to keep focusing there.

Topics: Charles River Ventures CRV TC



CRV hires Anna Khan as a general partner focused on enterprise

Kate Clark — 12:30 PM PDT · July 31, 2019

CRV, formerly known as Charles River Ventures, has hired Anna Khan as its 10th general partner. Khan joins from Bessemer Venture Partners where she's served as a vice president since 2016.

CRV invests across industries, with a portfolio that includes Bird and Airtable, among others. The venture capital firm is currently investing out of its 17th fund, a $600 million vehicle that closed in 2018.

Founded in 1970, CRV is amongst the older VC firms. While Khan isn't the firm's first female GP — Annie Kadavy, now a general partner at Redpoint Ventures, joined CRV as a GP in 2012 — she will be the firm's only current female GP.

Despite an increasing number of firms tapping female talent, less than 10% of "decision-makers" at U.S. venture capital firms are female, according to Axios. Female founders, meanwhile, attract just over 2% of venture capital dollars.

Khan joins CRV alongside another new hire, former Social Capital partner Kristin Baker Spohn. Both Khan and Spohn, a venture partner, will focus on CRV's enterprise practice, where they'll work with Airtable, Drift, Iterable, SignalFx and more.

CRV'S NEWEST VENTURE PARTNER, KRISTIN BAKER SPOHN

"As is often the case, we were introduced to both [Khan and Spohn] through friends of CRV, and from our earliest conversations knew they would add tremendously to the firm," CRV general partner Murat Bicer said in a statement. "Kristin brings an impressive depth of knowledge in healthcare and a charisma that speaks to early entrepreneurs and seasoned executives alike, while Anna has an immense understanding of the SaaS world and an energy that has seen her accomplish so much in a relatively short period of time."

Khan, an investor in ScaleFactor, NewVoiceMedia and Intercom, previously founded Launch X, an accelerator that helps female entrepreneurs learn how to raise capital for their businesses.

Spohn's been an active angel investor since leaving Social Capital. She exited the once high-flying venture capital fund last year following Social Capital co-founder Chamath Palihapitiya's decision to no longer raise outside capital.

The Venture Twins

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Kate Clark

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Kate Clark was a reporter at TechCrunch covering venture capital and startups.

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The Venture Twins

At just 24, identical twins Justine and Olivia Moore might be CRV's secret weapon

Kate Clark

9:00 AM PDT · October 27, 2018

IMAGE CREDITS: JUSTINE AND OLIVIA MOORE

Justine and Olivia Moore like to introduce themselves together, otherwise, it can be a little confusing.

They live together in an apartment in Menlo Park. They share clothes. They both wear Rothy's sustainable ballet flats and are big fans of Glossier. Their desks are only inches apart, because yes, they work together too — and because they share a space heater.

The 24-year-old identical twins are venture investors at CRV, a Palo Alto-based venture capital firm they joined a little over a year ago. They call themselves The Venture Twins and they may just be the nearly 50-year-old firm's secret weapon.

CRV hired Justine and Olivia to work under Saar Gur, a general partner responsible for leading deals in Bird, DoorDash, Patreon, Dropbox and

ClassPass, in 2017. He was looking to expand CRV's consumer team when he found Justine, a recent Stanford economics graduate who was finishing a year-long stint at Goldman Sachs.

It wasn't long before Justine's references were urging Saar to hire her twin sister, too. "They are such a good team;" "You should hire both of them;" "They work great together," they'd tell him.

The Portland natives have an impressive resume. At Stanford, they launched Cardinal Ventures, a first-of-its-kind on-campus startup incubator. Plus, one might say they were bred for venture capital. Their mother, Darcy Moore, was also a VC. She retired when they were just five years old, but the pair remember walking into pitch meetings and observing demo days before starting kindergarten.

"The cool thing to say is 'oh, I never wanted to be in venture; I stumbled into it,' but we *have* always wanted to be in venture," Justine told TechCrunch.

Breaking in

Despite long-held ambitions to become venture capitalists, Justine and Olivia enrolled at Stanford in 2012 to study journalism. After some time on The Stanford Daily covering the entrepreneurship beat, they realized journalism wasn't going to quench their thirst for innovation.

Their junior year, they created Cardinal Ventures. The program gives two cohorts of 12 to 20 startups per year $5,000 in non-dilutive capital and supports them with 10 weeks of mentorship and programming. For the twins, Cardinal granted them access to some of Silicon Valley's best investors.

JUSTINE (LEFT) AND HER TWIN SISTER OLIVIA ARE VENTURE INVESTORS AT CRV.

By their senior year, they were fielding internship offers from those top-notch VCs. Olivia accepted an internship at First Round Capital, while Justine went to work at Cowboy Ventures. After graduation, they *both* went to work as analysts at Goldman.

After one year on the public equities team for Olivia and the private equities team for Justine, the twins were ready to transition into venture for good. They had met with CRV's partners during their Cardinal Ventures days and felt the opportunity to work with Gur on consumer tech investing was something they couldn't pass up. That, and the firm was willing to give them the freedom they needed to build their personal brand.

Building a brand

In addition to their Twitter account, @VentureTwins, and a very active Medium page, Justine and Olivia have a weekly newsletter called Accelerated that's racked up some 5,200 subscribers since it launched one year ago.

The newsletter is written for college students. It provides the week's biggest news in tech, notable internship and job openings, recommended reads and surveys on industry topics and trends for readers to complete.

"We are from Oregon and we weren't engineering majors, so I think the problem we had and part of the reason we went to Goldman was because it's really hard if you aren't from here to understand how it works," Justine said. "Our full-time job is keeping up to date on Silicon Valley, what the hot trends are, who's hiring, so we decided, why don't we spend a couple of hours a week creating a newsletter that is the resource we wish we had when we were in college."

Accelerated has a team of 120 campus ambassadors who Justine and Olivia can text at any time to ask about various topics. "Do you like this company?" "Have you ever heard of this product?" Things like that. So far, the Accelerated network has helped the twins source five potential deals, two of which became CRV portfolio companies. That's Harper Wilde, a direct-to-consumer bra retailer, and Uppercase, which helps D2C companies open brick-and-mortar stores.

Some takeaways from our recent campus ambassador survey:
👀 Twitter is most abandoned social app, while IG usage has spiked
👂 11% watch ASMR videos
📷 50% have more than one IG account
🥤 20% use CBD products, and 54% would try a CBD product from a major brand (e.g. Coke)

— Justine Moore (@venturetwins) October 12, 2018

"I think we really underestimated what it would be," Olivia said. "But being in someone's inbox every week is this really fun and cool connection."

CRV isn't known for its D2C investments; in fact, Harper Wilde was its first ever. With their instincts, youth and network, the twins have quickly proved their value to the firm.

Better together

At this point, you're probably wondering how two 24-year-old siblings can live and work together and not want to kill each other. And it may sound too cutesy and convenient, but they think they're better together.

"Honestly, we've gotten closer over time," Olivia said. "Going to Stanford together and as we've moved into the professional world, we've found we are able to communicate really effectively as a team and get things done because there is less worry about stepping on toes or hurting someone else's feelings."

The twins plan to stick together, though it's not necessarily a requirement. For now, they'll be keeping their residence in Menlo Park, where they have the space to dog-sit former 23andMe president Andy Page's Bernedoodle.

In 20 years, who knows, maybe Justine and Olivia will be known as some of the greatest consumer VCs the industry has ever seen. They are smart, refreshingly modest and they seem to know their stuff.

"We'd love to be doing this in the long term if we're good at it," Justine said.

Olivia agreed.

Topics: classpass cowboy ventures CRV DoorDash First Round Capital harper wilde Highland Capital Partners Instagram literature oregon palo alto president stanford Venture

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